

Party Bus Photo Shoot

· **GAMEPLAN** ·

Your complete on-site shot list and checklist

SHOOT DATE · Friday, May 16, 2026

Today's goal is to capture the assets we don't have yet — multiple exterior angles for every bus, clean empty "showroom" interiors, detail close-ups, and the first video content for the fleet. By the end of the shoot we'll have 80+ photos and 12+ video clips ready to upgrade the website, Instagram, and ads.

EXPECTED SHOOT TIME	3 - 4 hours
NUMBER OF BUSES	_____ (fill in on-site)
PHOTOS TO CAPTURE	80+
VIDEO CLIPS TO CAPTURE	12+

BEFORE YOU LEAVE THE HOUSE

- ☐ Phone charged to 100% — and turn Low Power Mode off
- ☐ Portable charger + Lightning/USB-C cable packed
- ☐ Microfiber cloth — clean windows + glossy surfaces on-site
- ☐ Small step stool if you have one (for high exterior angles)
- ☐ Water + snacks — you'll be out there 3-4 hours

PAGE 2 · THE DAY

Time Plan & Equipment

TIME PLAN

TIME	BLOCK	WHAT
6:30 AM	Wake / coffee	Home — pack the bag from page 1
7:00 AM	Arrive at the lot	Prep walk-through, confirm bus order
7:15 - 8:30	BLOCK 1 — Golden Hour Exteriors	Soft warm side light. All buses, all 12 exterior shots.
8:30 - 9:00	Break / re-stage	Move buses if needed, hydrate, review.
9:00 - 10:30	BLOCK 2 — Interior Showroom	Each bus: LEDs off, then full color cycle.
10:30 - 11:30	BLOCK 3 — Detail / Macro	Bar, pole, ceiling, leather, chrome, signage.
11:30 - 12:00	BLOCK 4 — Video Clips	Walkarounds + LED cycles + drive-by + verticals.
12:00 PM	Wrap	Review files on phone, back-up, head home.

EQUIPMENT CHECKLIST

- ☐ Phone (iPhone — set to 4K video @ 60fps, photo HEIF mode)
- ☐ Portable charger + cable
- ☐ Microfiber cloth — clean windows & glossy surfaces
- ☐ Tripod or phone gimbal (optional — better video stability)
- ☐ Small light or ring light (optional — interior shadow fill)
- ☐ Step stool (optional — for high exterior angles)
- ☐ Roll of black gaffer tape — hide cords + quick labels
- ☐ Water + snacks
- ☐ Notebook + pen — capture bus serials / nicknames

PAGE 3 · BEFORE YOU SHOOT EACH BUS

Pre-Shoot Bus Prep

Run this checklist on every bus before you start shooting it. 5 minutes of prep saves you 30 minutes of cleanup in editing.

- ☐ Wash exterior — or at minimum wipe down dust, especially glossy panels
- ☐ Clean all windows inside and out
- ☐ Vacuum interior carpet / floor
- ☐ Wipe down leather seats with leather cleaner
- ☐ Remove personal items from inside — water bottles, jackets, papers
- ☐ Test LEDs — confirm all colors work: red, blue, green, purple, white, color cycle
- ☐ Test dance pole — wipe down, confirm secure
- ☐ Test sound system — confirm working
- ☐ Confirm bar / cup holders / glassware staged cleanly
- ☐ Turn AC on cold for interiors — keeps lens from fogging when door opens
- ☐ Park bus where it gets soft side light — NOT direct sun on front
- ☐ Position so background is clean — no other vehicles, no clutter

PHOTO TECHNIQUE TIPS

- Shoot landscape AND vertical for every key shot.
- Tap to focus on the subject, then tap-and-hold to lock exposure.
- For interiors: open all doors, turn on all LEDs, hold still on the shutter.
- Avoid HDR mode for LED interior shots — it kills color saturation.
- Take 3 of each shot — best one wins.

PAGE 4 · PER BUS · BLOCK 1

Exterior Shot List

Repeat this list for every bus in the fleet. Right now we only have 1 exterior — we need at least 10 strong exteriors per bus by end of today.

EXTERIOR — REQUIRED SHOTS

- ☐ 1. Front 3/4 view — wide, full bus, slight low angle (hero shot)
- ☐ 2. Side profile — straight on, level
- ☐ 3. Rear 3/4 view — show rear lights / signage
- ☐ 4. Straight rear — flat back, badge / logo visible
- ☐ 5. Front straight on — grill / lights centered
- ☐ 6. Detail: chrome accents or wheel close-up
- ☐ 7. Detail: branded badge or any signage on the bus
- ☐ 8. Open passenger door angle — entry + peek of glowing LED interior
- ☐ 9. Tall angle — step stool or arm overhead, shows roof line
- ☐ 10. Low angle — crouched, makes the bus look imposing / luxury
- ☐ 11. Wide environmental shot — bus in setting, room to breathe (ad backgrounds)
- ☐ 12. Vertical 9:16 hero portrait — for Instagram Reels covers

GOLDEN HOUR PRO TIP

Golden hour = soft light from a low angle. Position the bus so the sun is BEHIND you when shooting the front — that lights up the grill and makes the paint pop.

Shoot WIDE so you can crop in later. You can always zoom in in post — you can never zoom out.

PAGE 5 · PER BUS · BLOCK 2

Interior Shot List

We already have 8 strong interiors, but they're all of one or two buses. We need a full "showroom" set for every bus.

LEDS OFF · CLEAN SHOWROOM LOOK

- ☐ 1. Wide interior — from rear toward driver, doors open, natural light
- ☐ 2. Wide interior — from front toward rear
- ☐ 3. Side-by-side — show seating depth + leg room
- ☐ 4. Ceiling detail — star ceiling / fiber optics / finishes
- ☐ 5. Floor detail — wood, carpet, any LED floor strips

LEDS ON · EACH COLOR

- ☐ 6. Wide interior · BLUE
- ☐ 7. Wide interior · RED / WINE
- ☐ 8. Wide interior · GREEN
- ☐ 9. Wide interior · PURPLE
- ☐ 10. Wide interior · WHITE / WARM
- ☐ 11. Wide interior · Color-cycle mid-transition (catch the rainbow)

DETAIL SHOTS INSIDE

- ☐ 12. Bar / cup holders / glassware staged
- ☐ 13. Dance pole — angled, floor to ceiling
- ☐ 14. Captain chair / front bench
- ☐ 15. Sound system / speaker grill close-up
- ☐ 16. TV / screen detail (if applicable)
- ☐ 17. AC / climate controls
- ☐ 18. Door open from inside looking out (frames the bus)
- ☐ 19. Driver's compartment / dash (if photogenic)

INTERIOR PRO TIPS

Turn AC on cold before shooting — prevents lens fog when the door opens.

No flash, ever. Phone flash kills LED color. Use natural light + the LEDs themselves.

Open all doors for the wide shots — light from multiple angles fills shadows.

PAGE 6 · BLOCK 4 · 12 ESSENTIALS

Video Clips

Right now we have zero video for the fleet. That changes today. Shoot everything in 4K at 60fps so we can slow it down later. Each clip should be 10-20 seconds.

FOR EACH BUS

- ☐ 1. Slow exterior walkaround — front, clockwise to back, ~20 sec · landscape AND vertical
- ☐ 2. Interior pan — slow front-to-rear pan, LEDs cycling, ~15 sec
- ☐ 3. Door-opening reveal — closed → swung open, LED interior shows, ~5 sec · slow-mo
- ☐ 4. LED color cycle — fixed camera, watch the colors change, ~20 sec

ONCE PER FLEET

- ☐ 5. Slow drive-by — park-and-walk, bus rolls past camera, ~10 sec
- ☐ 6. Boarding shot — person stepping in, door closing behind, ~10 sec (use yourself or a friend)
- ☐ 7. Staged detail — champagne pour / cup clink / hands raised (brief, moody)
- ☐ 8. Drone shot (skip if no drone)
- ☐ 9. Sunset silhouette — bus parked, golden hour, ~10 sec

VERTICAL CONTENT · 9:16 · REELS & TIKTOK

- ☐ 10. "Step inside" — first-person POV opening door, walking in
- ☐ 11. "Color cycle" — vertical fixed camera on interior, LEDs cycling
- ☐ 12. "Walkaround vertical" — slow vertical pan around the bus

VIDEO PRO TIPS

Walk SLOWLY on walkarounds — it'll always feel too fast in the final cut.

Tap-and-hold to lock exposure before recording — keeps LEDs from blowing out.

Shoot vertical AND horizontal versions of everything. Repurposing is way easier than reshooting.

PAGE 7 · BLOCK 3 · THE MONEY SHOTS

Detail / Macro & Staged Shots

Reserve the last 30 minutes for these — they're the shots that elevate the brand from "rental" to "luxury experience."

STAGED LIFESTYLE

- ☐ Champagne flutes lined up on the bar — soft LED glow behind them
- ☐ Champagne bottle + bucket (if available on-site)
- ☐ Phone playing music + drinks in foreground
- ☐ Wedding style: white flowers on seat + champagne (for wedding marketing)
- ☐ Bachelorette style: sashes, balloons, fun props on seat (if available)
- ☐ Corporate style: closed laptop + coffee + briefcase on captain chair
- ☐ "Empty looking-back" shot — door open, looking from outside into glowing interior at dusk

DETAILS · CLOSE / MACRO

- ☐ Hands on dance pole — mid-grip, gold rings or watch visible (adds luxury)
- ☐ Glass of bubbly held up — LED bokeh behind
- ☐ Driver in chauffeur attire opening passenger door (if drivers available)
- ☐ Close-up of LED strip — fully saturated, abstract
- ☐ Close-up of star ceiling lights
- ☐ Close-up of stitched leather seam
- ☐ Wheel + tire detail
- ☐ Side mirror reflecting sky or sunrise

PAGE 8 · WRAP & HAND-OFF

Post-Shoot Checklist

BEFORE YOU LEAVE THE LOT

- ☐ Quickly review hero shots on phone — anything missed?
- ☐ Confirm every bus got: 12 exteriors, 19 interiors, 4 video clips minimum
- ☐ Note bus identifiers in your notebook (so you know which is which back home)

WITHIN 2 HOURS OF GETTING HOME

- ☐ Plug phone in & back up all photos / videos to iCloud + Google Photos (redundancy)
- ☐ Create folder on computer: /Photos/2026-05-16 Bus Shoot/
- ☐ Inside that folder, create: Exteriors/ · Interiors/ · Details/ · Video/
- ☐ Move files into matching folders
- ☐ Message Frederick the folder location so I can pull the best ones into the website

HAND-OFF TO ME

- ☐ Pick your 5 favorite exteriors (one per bus)
- ☐ Pick your 10 favorite interiors (variety of colors)
- ☐ Pick your 3 favorite video clips
- ☐ Text Frederick when ready

“Every great party bus brand is built on great photos. After today, we'll have everything we need to make Party Bus R Us the best-looking fleet in the DMV.”

— FREDERICK